Answers and talk notes

Write and Solve Equations Using Addition or Subtraction

What your student is learning

Tonight we solve equations where something was SUBTRACTED from the variable — by adding it back to both sides.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** Adding 4. Adding 4 undoes subtracting 4.
2. **B.** 8. x = 8, because 3 + 5 = 8.
3. **C.** 16. n = 16, because 6 + 10 = 16.
4. **D.** 19. k = 19, because 12 + 7 = 19.
5. **A.** Yes, because 20 − 9 = 11. Yes, because 20 − 9 = 11, so both sides match.
6. **C.** $15. She started with $15, because 9 + 6 = 15.

Talk about it

Why does adding undo the subtraction? What must you do to the other side?

Home mission

Fill a bowl with beans without counting. Take out 18 and count what is left. Say s − 18 = your count. Can your student find s? Pour them back to check.

When they are stuck, ask

- What operation do you see in the equation?
- What is the opposite of that operation?
- Did you do it to both sides?

Try not to say

- Subtract 7 from both sides to solve x − 7 = 15.
- You only need to change the side with the variable.
- Skip the check, you did the steps right.